

Employer and Community Partnership Overview

Intended user: Employers, community organizations, industry professionals, and prospective partners

Purpose and directions

Purpose: Distinguish the current and proposed ways a community member or organization may support Culinary Arts learning.

When to use: Use to identify the participation route that matches the intended contribution before beginning a conversation with the school.

Five different participation routes

Participation route	Purpose and current boundary
General community participation	Career conversations, demonstrations, site visits, classroom connections, and other approved exposure activities may support learning without creating employment or placement.
Cottage client opportunity	An approved request may become a client-centered learning experience when it fits curriculum, schedule, safety, resources, student readiness, and teacher supervision.
Guest speaking or industry feedback	An industry professional may explain career practice, demonstrate an approved skill, review student work, or provide structured feedback while the teacher retains instructional authority.
Mercantile/capstone participation	A community participant may support a future culminating event through an approved guest role, feedback, collaboration, attendance, event support, or sponsorship only where district rules allow.
Proposed senior WBL training station	A workplace could host a student only after the course is authorized and the site, mentor, duties, training plan, legal and insurance conditions, transportation, supervision, and records workflow are approved.

What all participation routes share

- Student learning comes before labor, publicity, production volume, or convenience.
- Preparation comes before independence; responsibility matches demonstrated readiness.
- The teacher or authorized district owner confirms the activity, scope, schedule, supervision, and communication route before any commitment.
- Private student, employer, agreement, evaluation, incident, hours, and placement records remain in approved restricted systems.

From interest to an approved activity

Step	What happens
1. Identify the route	Clarify whether the idea concerns general participation, a Cottage request, guest expertise, the Mercantile/capstone, or a possible future training station.
2. Review fit	The school reviews educational value, timing, safety, supervision, student readiness, facilities, resources, accessibility, and records needs.
3. Confirm authority	The correct teacher, coordinator, administrator, or district owner confirms what is permitted before plans are announced.
4. Deliver and review	The approved activity is carried out within its agreed boundaries and reviewed for learning value.

Interest is not approval

A public resource or planning conversation does not create a partnership, placement, client commitment, sponsorship, or service agreement. Use only an approved, monitored route when one is identified.